

Greater China Auto, EV and EV battery

China EVs' Sept sales: behind or in line; Leapmotor YoY outperformed peers

Industry Overview

BYD +17% YoY/5% MoM: export/domestic recovery inline

BYD reported total September wholesales volume, including PVs and CVs, of 463k units, up 17% YoY/5% MoM. YT-September sales were down 4% YoY to 3.1mn units, accounting for 68% of our 2026 sales forecasts. BYD posted export sales of 181k units in September, up 154% YoY/down 5% MoM, and export sales contribution reached 39%.

XPeng September delivery -1% YoY/+5% MoM: behind

XPeng reported 41k unit deliveries in September, down 1% YoY/up 5% MoM. 3Q26 sales volume reported 118k units, accounting for 97% of our 3Q26 estimate, and in-line with its guidance of 115-121k units. YT-September sales volume came in at 284k units, down 9% YoY, accounting for 63% of our 2026 sales volume forecasts. On September 17, 2026, XPeng officially launched G9L, a premium flagship SUV in China, while the model's global launch will take place in France in October.

Li Auto September delivery -6% YoY/-16% MoM: inline

Li Auto reported 32k unit deliveries in September, down 6% YoY/16% MoM. 3Q26 sales came in at 100k units, accounting for 100% of our 3Q26 estimate, and in-line with its guidance of 95-100k units. YT-September sales volume came in at 293k units, down 1% YoY, accounting for 71% of our 2026 sales volume forecasts. In September, Li Auto launched the new Li MEGA Home and i9 Home, and plans to launch new i6 in October.

NIO September delivery +8% YoY/+4% MoM: inline

NIO reported 37k unit deliveries in September, up 8% YoY/4% MoM. 3Q26 sales came in at 109k units, accounting for 99% of our 3Q26 estimate, and in-line with its guidance of 108-111k units. YT-September sales volume came in at 300k units, up 49% YoY, accounting for 72% of our 2026 sales volume forecasts. NIO delivered 8.8k/7.3k units of ONVO/Firefly in September.

Leapmotor delivery slightly behind BofAe; Xiaomi in line

(1) **Leapmotor** delivered 106k units in September, up 59% YoY/2% MoM, accounting for 33% of our 3Q26 sales volume forecasts; 3Q26 sales volume reported 323k units, accounting for 96% of our 3Q26 estimate, slightly behind; (2) **Xiaomi** delivered >40k units in September; (3) **VOYAH**: September delivery came in at 13k units, down 14% YoY/flat MoM.

Geely September sales up 7% YoY/8% MoM: ahead

Geely's September sales came in at 292k units, up 7% YoY/8% MoM. YT-September sales were up 3% YoY to 2.2mn units, accounting for 70% of our 2026 forecasts and 65% of Geely's 2026 sales target at 3.45mn units (+14% YoY). Overseas sales were up 162% YoY/down 3% MoM at 107k units in September, and export sales contribution reached 37%.

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PEV: passenger electric vehicle

BEV: battery electric vehicle

PHEV: plug-in electric vehicle

EREV: extended range electric vehicle

ICEV: internal combustion engine vehicle

ESS: energy storage system

PV: passenger vehicle

CV: commercial vehicle

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Geely September sales up 7% YoY/8% MoM: ahead

Geely's September sales came in at 292k units, up 7% YoY/8% MoM. YT-September sales were up 3% YoY to 2.2mn units, accounting for 70% of our 2026 forecasts and 65% of Geely's 2026 sales target at 3.45mn units (+14% YoY). In September, the Geely brand sales volume came in at 236k units, up 7% YoY/9% MoM, among which Galaxy sales volume read 130k units, up 8% YoY/10% MoM. For Lynk & Co brand, total sales volume reached 18k units in September, down 44% YoY/up 9% MoM. For Zeekr brand, total sales volume reached 37k units in September, up 104% YoY/1% MoM. Overseas sales were up 162% YoY/down 3% MoM at 107k units in September, and export sales contribution reached 37%. In September, Geely's domestic wholesales were 185k units, down 20% YoY/up 16% MoM.

GWM September sales: -14% YoY/+1% MoM: inline

Great Wall Motor (GWM)'s September sales came in at 115k units, down 14% YoY/up 1% MoM. YT-September sales were down 0.3% YoY to 920k units, accounting for 68% of our 2026 forecasts. In September, the Haval brand sales volume came in at 67k units, down 19% YoY/up 2% MoM. For the WEY brand, total sales volume reached 7k units in September, down 37% YoY/5% MoM. For the Tank brand, total volume sales were down 29% YoY/14% MoM to 15k units in September. For the ORA brand, September sales came in at 11k units, up 79% YoY/2% MoM. Pick-up truck sales came in at 15k units in September, up 16% YoY/22% MoM. Overseas sales were up 19% YoY/down 4% MoM at 60k units in September, and export sales contribution reached 52%.

Exhibit 1: Major auto brands' September sales vs BofA forecast

In September, Leapmotor delivered highest YoY growth

	Sep sales (unit)	YoY	MoM	YT-Sep sales (unit)	YT-Sep YoY	July-Sep sales of 3Q26 BofA forecast	Jan-Sep % of BofA 2026 forecast
BYD	463,561	17%	5%	3,131,576	-4%	NA	68%
Geely	292,168	7%	8%	2,235,481	3%	NA	70%
GWM	114,944	-14%	1%	920,302	0%	NA	68%
Leapmotor	105,656	59%	2%	666,539	69%	96%	66%
Li	31,817	-6%	-16%	293,436	-1%	100%	71%
NIO	37,408	8%	4%	300,301	49%	99%	72%
XPeng	41,256	-1%	5%	284,367	-9%	97%	63%
VOYAH	13,025	-14%	0%	115,481	19%	NA	63%

Source: Company report, BofA Global Research estimates

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Exhibit 2: Major auto brands' monthly sales

In September, Leapmotor delivered highest YoY growth

	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	Jul-26	Aug-26	Sep-26	9M26
BYD	396,270	441,706	480,186	420,398	210,051	190,190	300,222	321,123	383,453	403,472	419,211	440,293	463,561	3,131,576
Geely	273,125	307,133	310,428	236,817	270,167	206,160	233,031	235,164	237,637	240,799	250,161	270,194	292,168	2,235,481
GWM	133,639	143,078	133,216	124,020	90,312	72,594	106,198	106,312	100,399	108,080	108,067	113,396	114,944	920,302
Leapmotor	66,657	70,289	70,327	60,423	32,059	28,067	50,029	71,387	81,569	93,376	101,267	103,129	105,656	666,539
Li	33,951	31,767	33,181	44,246	27,668	26,421	41,053	34,085	33,350	30,895	30,468	37,679	31,817	293,436
NIO	34,749	40,397	36,275	48,135	27,182	20,797	35,486	29,356	37,705	40,597	35,934	35,836	37,408	300,301
XPeng	41,581	42,013	36,728	37,508	20,011	15,256	27,415	31,011	32,158	40,126	38,027	39,107	41,256	284,367
VOYAH	15,224	17,218	20,005	17,537	10,515	8,358	15,019	15,146	13,003	14,223	13,189	13,003	13,025	115,481
YoY														
BYD	-6%	-12%	-5%	-18%	-30%	-41%	-20%	-16%	0%	5%	22%	18%	17%	-4%
Geely	35%	35%	24%	13%	1%	1%	0%	0%	1%	2%	5%	8%	7%	3%
GWM	23%	22%	5%	-8%	12%	-7%	8%	6%	-2%	-2%	4%	-2%	-14%	0%
Leapmotor	97%	84%	75%	42%	27%	11%	35%	74%	81%	95%	102%	81%	59%	69%
Li	-37%	-38%	-32%	-24%	-8%	1%	12%	0%	-18%	-15%	-1%	32%	-6%	-1%
NIO	64%	93%	76%	55%	96%	58%	136%	23%	62%	63%	71%	14%	8%	49%
XPeng	95%	76%	19%	2%	-34%	-50%	-17%	-12%	-4%	16%	4%	4%	-1%	-9%
VOYAH	52%	81%	100%	59%	31%	4%	50%	51%	30%	41%	25%	-4%	-14%	19%

Source: Company report

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Exhibit 3: BYD monthly sales

September sales were up 17% YoY

	Sep-26	YoY	9M26	9M26 YoY	BofA 2026 forecast	Hit rate
NEV	463,561	17.0%	3,131,576	-3.9%	4,607,622	68.0%
- PV	456,713	16.2%	3,078,544	-4.4%	4,541,772	67.8%
- BEV	273,143	33.2%	1,629,957	1.5%	2,372,203	68.7%
- PHEV	183,570	-2.4%	1,448,587	-10.2%	2,153,769	67.3%
- CV & others	6,848	113.3%	48,248	16.9%	65,850	73.3%
Total	463,561	17.0%	3,131,576	-3.9%	4,607,622	68.0%
Export sales	180,700	153.6%	1,342,404	92.6%	-	-
Export penetration	39.0%	-	42.9%	-	-	-

Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company report

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Exhibit 4: Geely's monthly sales

September sales were up 7% YoY

	Sep-26	YoY	9M26	9M26 YoY	BofA 2026 forecast	Hit rate
Geely	236,459	6.5%	1,750,960	-1.9%	2,454,908	71.3%
LYNK & CO	18,493	-43.8%	196,117	-18.8%	346,701	56.6%
Zeekr	37,216	103.8%	288,404	100.8%	398,748	72.3%
Total	292,168	7.0%	2,235,481	3.0%	3,200,357	69.9%
Export sales	106,685	162.4%	797,670	169.4%	-	-
Export contribution	36.5%	-	35.7%	-	-	-

Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company report

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Exhibit 5: GWM's monthly sales

September sales were down 14% YoY

	Sep-26	YoY	9M26	9M26 YoY	BofA 2026 forecast	Hit rate
Haval	66,558	-18.8%	515,080	-2.5%	707,447	72.8%
WEY	6,976	-36.7%	66,582	4.7%	178,962	37.2%
Pickup	15,020	16.4%	135,826	-0.3%	184,040	73.8%
Ora	11,202	79.1%	59,429	100.2%	82,795	71.8%
Tank	15,178	-29.2%	142,796	-13.5%	197,451	72.3%
Others	75	41.5%	288	65.5%	1,091	26.4%
Total	114,944	-14.0%	920,302	-0.3%	1,351,784	68.1%
Export sales	60,019	19.4%	475,977	42.4%	-	-

Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company report

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